

Spring flowers for containers

Plan ahead and plant up spring containers in fall. Many plants also provide a winter foliage display before the bulbs and bedding burst into life.

Plant bulbs from early- to late fall; allowing time for vernalization in frostproof containers. Snowdrops, an exception, are best potted up in leaf when in flower in spring. Small bulbs, such as crocus, grape hyacinth, and iris, are ideal for tiny pots, while tall daffodils and tulips look beautiful in large pots along with spring-flowering bedding plants, such as viola, wallflower, and primrose. Plant these over the bulbs to provide interest through winter and a dramatic display in spring. Use large, containerized shrubs, such as camellia and rhododendron, for their winter leaves, as well as spring blooms.



PERENNIAL SMALL

Aurinia saxatilis

BASKET OF GOLD Masses of long-lasting chrome-yellow flowers make this low-growing evergreen perennial a good choice for spring pots. The blooms sit above oval gray-green leaves. It will die back if exposed to high heat and humidity in summer.

↑9in (23cm) ↔12in (30cm)

☀️ 🌱 Z4-7



PERENNIAL SMALL

Bellis perennis

ENGLISH DAISY This mound-forming perennial, grown as an annual, produces midgreen leaves and, in spring, pink, white, or red single or double pompomlike flowers. Plant in containers with potting soil with spring bulbs.

↑↔8in (20cm)

☀️ 🌱 🌱 Z4-8



SHRUB SMALL

Cassiope 'Edinburgh'

CASSIOPE Plant this dwarf evergreen shrub in a container of gritty potting mix alongside short bulbs, such as species tulips. From spring to summer, tiny scalelike dark green leaves and nodding, white bell-shaped flowers appear.

↑↔8in (20cm)

☀️ 🌱 🌱 Z2-6



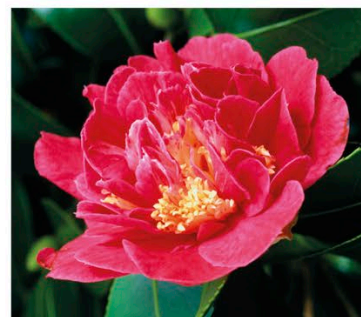
PERENNIAL SMALL

Bergenia silverlight

PIGSQUEAK Grow this evergreen perennial with spring bulbs in containers of soil-based potting mix. It has large, oval dark green leaves, which create a foil for the clusters of white flowers that appear on its red-tinged stems.

↑18in (45cm) ↔20in (50cm)

☀️ 🌱 🌱 Z3-8



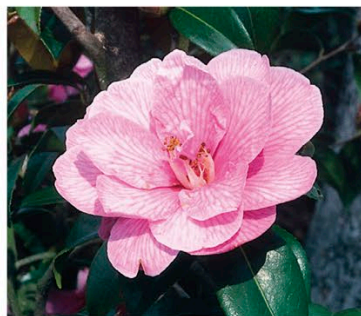
SHRUB LARGE

Camellia japonica

JAPANESE CAMELLIA Grow this upright evergreen shrub in large containers of acidic soil mix in a sheltered site where cold winds and late frosts will not damage its large red, pink, or white early spring flowers.

↑10ft (3m) ↔6ft (2m)

☀️ 🌱 🌱 Z7-9



SHRUB LARGE

Camellia x williamsii

CAMELLIA An evergreen shrub with oval, pointed, glossy green leaves and white, or red single or double pink blooms in spring. Varieties include 'Donation' (above) with pink, semidouble flowers. Plant in acidic soil mix. Water well in summer.

↑15ft (5m) ↔8ft (2.5m)

☀️ 🌱 🌱 Z7-9



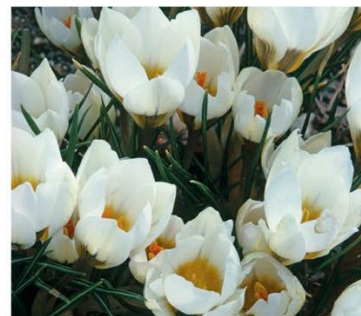
CLIMBER MEDIUM

Clematis 'Frances Rivis'

CLEMATIS Add height to a patio display with this spring-flowering deciduous clematis. Plant in a container of soil-based potting mix, with a trellis or pyramid to support the twining stems of divided foliage and bell-shaped violet-blue flowers.

↑10ft (3m)

☀️ 🌱 Z4-9



BULB SMALL

Crocus 'Snow Bunting'

CROCUS Plant this perennial corm in small pots in fall for an early spring display of fragrant white flowers with yellow centers and a purple blush on the outer petal surfaces. The grasslike leaves are green with white lines.

↑3in (7cm)

☀️ 🌱 🌱 Z3-8